FADE IN:

INT. HARBOR OFFICE - DAY

A cramped office above the docks. Rain streaks the window. MARGOT VELLANI, forties, sorts through crates of manifests.

MARGOT
You're late, Dario. The ship left an hour ago.
(not looking up)
Again.

DARIO PELLICANO, thin and breathless, drops a soaked umbrella in the corner.

DARIO (O.S.)
The tram broke down. I ran the last
(MORE)

DARIO (CONT'D)
mile, I swear, I ran all the way and I still missed it by ten minutes.

MARGOT
Ten minutes is a lifetime on the water.

CUT TO:

EXT. CARGO PIER - NIGHT

Floodlights and fog. Dario crosses the pier alone, boots echoing on the planks.

DARIO
Hello? Anyone? I have the papers for the Aurora.

SMASH CUT TO: